

“AI should belong to all; sovereignty isn’t optional”

With AI and open source innovation reshaping enterprise infrastructure, NxtGen is redefining control and sovereignty in technology. In an exclusive conversation, **A.S. Rajgopal** shares with **EFY's Rahul Chopra** and **Akanksha Sondhi Gaur** how the M platform, Indian talent, and GPU-powered AI use cases are driving a future that's smarter, sovereign, and India-focused.

A.S. Rajgopal, CEO & MD at NxtGen



Q. What is NxtGen, and what does its name signify?

A. The name NxtGen was never about next-generation technology alone. When we started around 2012, there was a lot of discussion about how companies rarely survive beyond a couple of decades. Our thinking was different; we wanted to build a company that would be aspirational for the next generation. Ideally, not just us, but our children and their peers should want to work here. That thought led to defining core values that went beyond technology. One such value was what we call ‘deep affection’, the same care and commitment with which you work with your children. The name NxtGen reflects that aspiration: building something enduring, values-driven, and meaningful for future generations.

Q. How do you explain your solutions to a non-technical CEO?

A. We position ourselves as a sovereign infrastructure services provider. From day one, we were clear that India is a large enough market to justify building deep, indigenous

technology capabilities. Sovereignty is not a recent buzzword for us; we have been thinking along these lines since inception. We embed sovereignty across cloud infrastructure and now across AI as well.

We do not commercially depend on global hyperscalers, but we actively collaborate with the global open source community. We bring open technologies onto infrastructure we own and control, ensuring full authority over data, operations, and technology. Our value proposition is consistent: deliver superior performance at a lower cost, through deep engineering rather than pricing gimmicks.

Q. How do you compete with hyperscalers like AWS, Azure, or Google Cloud?

A. We compete head-on. In fact, we have migrated more than 400 enterprises from AWS to NxtGen through a program we internally call ‘Rescue from AWS’. Hyperscalers are excellent for startups due to free credits and deep integrations. However, once businesses scale, costs often become prohibitive. Our sweet spot

is medium to large enterprises. We encourage startups to build on AWS, Azure, or Google Cloud but run their scaled operations with us. We provide complete infrastructure, migration support, security, and managed services.

Q. Are you simply a data centre company, or is your role broader?

A. While we operate five data centres today, we are not a co-location provider. Customers hand over their applications to us, and we deploy, secure, scale, and manage them. For example, for the Election Commission, TCS develops the application, and we take it from User Acceptance Testing (UAT) to production, ensuring scalability and security. That full-stack operational responsibility defines us.

Q. What is the M platform, and why did you build it?

A. In the AI space today, massive global investment and limited access to advanced technology and top talent especially in India create real constraints. We were clear that we could not compete on scale, so our focus was